Westbrook School Committee

~ Regular Meeting ~

Date: Wednesday, June 10, 2026
Time: 7:00 PM
Location: Westbrook High School (Room 114), 117 Stroudwater St. (Hybrid via Zoom)
Video: https://vimeo.com/1200268817
Packet: No agenda was published for this meeting (checked westbrookschools.org/page/westbrook-school-committee, 2026-10-24).

Timestamps below are clickable [0:00]-style links — they jump straight to that moment in the video.

This summary highlights the meeting's key discussions and decisions, with direct quotes and timestamps for verification — it is not a substitute for watching the full meeting. *Six of seven regular members were present (Brooke Reed absent); one student representative attended (the other graduated with the Class of 2026 days earlier). A largely ceremonial meeting honoring Teachers of the Year and retirees; every vote passed unanimously. Summarization necessarily condenses and selects; for complete context, nuance, and anything not covered, watch the full video at the link above. (Produced by: WestbrookCurrents.com)*

Unofficial summary. *This is produced by Westbrook Currents, an independent site — not the City of Westbrook — and may contain mistakes. For the official record, see the City's approved minutes and the meeting video.*

Recognition: Teachers of the Year & Retirees

Teachers of the Year [12:53]

Discussion Summary

One honoree per building: Michael Crawford (PE, Westbrook Middle School), Haley Tardiff (special education, Sacarappa School), Selena Mardin (kindergarten, Congin Elementary School), Kirk Nigren (building trades, Westbrook Regional Vocational Center), Brian Adams (math, Westbrook High School), and Hannah Gundersdorf (kindergarten, Canal School).

Key Decisions

Action Items

None.

Retirees — 211 Combined Years of Service [12:53]

Discussion Summary

Eric Jensen (7 years, Transportation), Jody Peterson and Melissa Foy (Transportation), Sandy Beasley (37 years, Canal), a Westbrook Middle School staff member with 39 years of service (name not clearly captured in the transcript), Maura McDermott (5 years, special education, Westbrook Middle School), Juni Dugas (25 years, administrative assistant, Westbrook Middle School), Paula Curcio (35 years, social studies, Westbrook Middle School), Marina Davis (7 years, math, Westbrook High School), Sarah Barker (cook, Westbrook High School), Nicole Sturgis (10 years, aspirations counselor, Westbrook High School), and Wendy Harvey (12 years, co-principal, Westbrook High School).

Key Decisions

Action Items

None.

Reports

Superintendent's Report [11:45]

Discussion Summary

The FY27 school budget referendum passed with roughly 70% voting yes, with unusually high turnout for a June vote. Superintendent Lancia thanked City staff, the elections team, and City Clerk Ledoux for processing results overnight.

The Class of 2026 graduated the prior Saturday; over $500,000 in scholarships were awarded at Class Night, plus roughly $62,000–$65,000 in scholarships/toolships at WRVC's awards night. An Adult Education graduation was also held.

2026–27 calendar: no staggered start — grades 1–12 begin Monday, August 31; kindergarten begins Wednesday, September 2; pre-K opens Thursday, September 3. Staff back-to-school luncheon is Friday, August 28.

Special services leadership restructuring: Director of Special Services Kelly Fogg retired last year; three searches for a replacement were unsuccessful, and Fogg has worked this year as a 3-day-a-week contracted consultant. Dr. Lancia proposed keeping two full-time assistant directors (one fully general-fund funded; one funded 20% general fund / 80% Maine Department of Education, reflecting that position's oversight of pre-K special education and “child find” requirements) and adding a third assistant director for one year only, funded from the savings of not filling the director position plus increased state funding share — no new general-fund money — while Fogg continues as a paid consultant. In discussion, Cavallaro confirmed the new position is a one-year-only bargaining-unit contract to be reassessed before the FY28 budget; Poitras asked for full salary/structure details; Mancuso confirmed the savings should fully cover the position (aside from possible benefits costs) and that no board action was being requested that evening. Lancia explained the special education director role is difficult to fill statewide due to its specific certification requirements and small candidate pools, and that partnering with a neighboring district's director hasn't been explored, given Westbrook's position as the county's largest special education program, but remains open to it.

Key Decisions

Action Items

None.

Spring Assessment Data — Dr. Kim O'Donnell [34:30]

Discussion Summary

Dr. O'Donnell, who also announced she is leaving after six years for Scarborough Public Schools, presented NWEA growth and achievement data comparing 2024–25 to 2025–26 across grades K–10, showing generally stable-to-improving trends districtwide — Westbrook High School and Westbrook Middle School both holding at or above roughly 60% of students meeting growth targets, with similar positive patterns at Congin, Canal, and Sacarappa elementary schools. In response to questions from Cavallaro, she distinguished “achievement” (performance against grade-level expectation) from “growth target” (predicted year-over-year progress), and said district benchmarking data could be pulled with more lead time.

Key Decisions

Action Items

None.

Chair's Report [45:48]

Discussion Summary

Thanked outgoing senior student representative Tina for her service, having just watched her graduate, and welcomed Jamila Mohamed Ahmed continuing into her third year as student representative.

Shared a parent message praising Congin Elementary principal Mark Bisson's leadership, tying it to the achievement gains just presented (Congin raised math and reading proficiency by nearly 12% over two years while serving a growing share of students in poverty and with disabilities).

Reported ongoing conversations with City staff about pesticide/fertilizer use on shared school/municipal athletic fields, including an informal meeting with City Administrator Angela Holmes and Mayor David Morse. Field-maintenance contracts have not been rebid in some time; the plan is to gather information over the summer so requests for proposals accounting for the school department's field needs can go out in the fall.

Key Decisions

Action Items

None.

Student Representative Report — Jamila Mohamed Ahmed [49:50]

Discussion Summary

End-of-year wind-down districtwide: step-up and field days at the elementary and middle schools, a district-wide 4th grade Beach Day sponsored by the Westbrook Education Foundation, Sacarappa's end-of-year picnic and field day, Westbrook Middle School's 8th grade promotion (June 16, dance after), the last day of school (June 17), a Congin PTO family fun night, and Westbrook High School finals.

Key Decisions

Action Items

None.

Subcommittee Reports [51:52]

Discussion Summary

Policy (Cavallaro) and Educational Programs (Rice): no meetings in May. Finance (Poitras): no update. Facilities (reported by Dr. Lancia in Brooke Reed's absence): the committee toured Sacarappa School in May, including the roof where the school's solar panels are installed and generating power.

Key Decisions

Action Items

None.

Old Business

11.1–11.5 — Final Approval of Five Items Held Over From First Approval (Taken in the Aggregate) [55:12]

Discussion Summary

Policy JICJ (student device use/cell-phone ban), Policy EEA (student transportation), Policy IKB (homework), the MLTI purchase for 2026–2027, and the Yonder pouch fund reallocation.

Notably, JICJ and the Yonder pouch funding had each split 5–1 at first approval on May 13, with Noreen Poitras the lone dissent both times on student-safety grounds — at final approval, she herself moved this aggregate motion, which included both items.

Key Decisions

✓ Approved 6–0 by show of hands (Reed not yet present), moved by Noreen Poitras, seconded by Katy Rice.

Action Items

None.

New Business

12.1 — Ten Administrator/Teacher Nominations (Taken in the Aggregate), First and Final Approval [56:35]

Discussion Summary

Nurse (elementary school, building name unclear in the transcript), Kindergarten Teacher (Sacarappa), two Pre-Kindergarten Teachers (Canal), Grade 3 Teacher (Sacarappa), Grade 2 Teacher (Canal), Social Studies Teacher (Westbrook High School), a Special Education Teacher (Westbrook High School), School Counselor (Westbrook High School), and Career Readiness School Counselor (Westbrook High School).

Key Decisions

✓ Approved 6–0, moved by Noreen Poitras, seconded by Erin Cavallaro.

Action Items

None.

12.2 — Superintendent's Summer Hiring-Decision Waiver, First and Final Approval [58:17]

Discussion Summary

Allows Dr. Lancia to hire teachers over the summer without waiting for committee nomination (hires reported at the next meeting); Lancia clarified a packet typo — the waiver covers teacher hires only, not administrators.

Key Decisions

✓ Approved 6–0, moved by Katy Rice, seconded by Noreen Poitras.

Action Items

None.

12.3 — Hire an Additional Pre-K General Education Teacher and Pre-K Ed Tech, First and Final Approval [59:45]

Discussion Summary

In response to a question from Dr. Flynn Ross, Dr. Lancia confirmed this is driven by enrollment demand: the pre-K program is expanding to three classrooms/six sessions (three teachers, three ed techs), with 74 students already enrolled and a week still remaining before the deadline. Canal School is now at its space maximum; additional enrollment brings additional state subsidy through the October 1 count.

Key Decisions

✓ Approved 6–0, moved by Katy Rice, seconded by Allison Brunette.

Action Items

None.

Important Dates

Upcoming Meetings & Events [01:01:49]

Discussion Summary

June 17: last day of school (half day). August 5, 5:00 PM: Finance Committee (Central Office). August 12, 7:00 PM: next regular School Committee meeting (Room 114, Westbrook High School). August 28–29: staff back-to-school days. August 31: first day of school.

Key Decisions

Action Items

None.

Executive Session

Recess Into Executive Session — Personnel Matter [01:03:24]

Discussion Summary

Pursuant to 1 M.R.S.A. §405(6)(A) (personnel matters).

Per the chair's announced change to the agenda order at the start of the meeting, the committee adjourned directly from executive session with no further public action.

Key Decisions

✓ Approved 6–0, moved by Erin Cavallaro, seconded by Noreen Poitras.

Action Items

None.

How this was made

This summary was produced from the meeting video (linked above, hosted on the City's Vimeo showcase). The audio was transcribed with AI-assisted speech-to-text and speaker identification. This process cross-checked names against the official School Committee roster, attributed speakers from context (introductions, roll-call order, direct address by the Chair) rather than the raw diarization labels alone, and drafted this summary and the quoted excerpts. Quotes are lightly cleaned of filler words/false starts but not reworded. No agenda or back-up packet was published for this meeting (checked westbrookschools.org, 2026-10-24); this summary is drawn from the video/transcript alone. Review tier: Not reviewed.

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